

Boston Fed and MIT release open source CBDC software

The Federal Reserve Bank of Boston and MIT's Digital Currency Initiative have released open source research software to facilitate the creation of a 'theoretical' central bank digital currency (CBDC).

The Boston branch of the US central bank and MIT have been working together on CBDCs for nearly two years. The new announcement moves them one step closer to a technical framework that might underpin a US CBDC.

The bank has been looking into technical concerns in CBDC development, such as whether distributed ledger technology could even sustain a digital currency.



The development of OpenCDBC is just the first step of the project. Phase two will examine what, if any, trade-offs there might be with other sets of features, as well as test the different designs and features not included in phase one. Phase two will also look into privacy and interoperability, among other things.

The Boston Fed's research software comes only weeks after the Federal Reserve issued its own white paper addressing policy issues highlighted by CBDCs and their applications. The policy paper raised two major concerns: privacy and financial stability hazards. Before considering adopting or constructing a CBDC, the Fed stated it would need an explicit law from Congress permitting it to do so.

Trousseau makes it easier to manage secrets in Kubernetes

Today, managing secrets to protect access to sensitive data in Kubernetes is complicated. It adds lots of components that are troublesome for security professionals. As a result, this security layer in Kubernetes is not optimal.

Trousseau open source software, which is available now, addresses this challenge. Secrets management can now be added to Kubernetes along with support for any key management encryption, starting with HashiCorp Vault. The Trousseau open source software is available on GitHub.

Romuald Vandepoel, principal cloud architect with Ondat and the project lead for Trousseau, said, "There have been previous projects that attempted to solve this problem, but they required adding lots of components. Naturally, security teams didn't like that approach because it introduced additional complexity making security more difficult. Secrets management has always been one of the most difficult issues in Kubernetes and the Trousseau Vault integration provides the long-sought answer to that problem."

Trousseau uses Kubernetes etcd to store API object definitions and states. The Kubernetes secrets are shipped into the etcd key-value store database using an in-flight envelope encryption scheme with a remote transit key saved in a KMS. Secrets protected and encrypted with Trousseau and its native Kubernetes integration can connect with a key management system to secure database credentials, a configuration file or TLS (transport layer security) certificate that contains critical information and is easily accessible by an application using the standard Kubernetes API primitives.

Trousseau is currently being rolled out in a production customer implementation on Suse Rancher Kubernetes Engine 2 leveraging Ondat as the data management platform, along with Hashicorp Vault.

Amplification raises US\$ 6.6 million in seed funding

Amplification, developer of an open source project that streamlines and automates backend development, has raised US\$ 6.6 million in seed funding. The company said the capital will be used to expand its open source community, support product



development and introduce an enterprise version of the platform.

"I built Amplification as an open source project to make coding more efficient by eliminating repetitive coding tasks—a prevalent issue that plagues developers and which I

encountered first-hand when I was a technology leader. Since releasing the project in January 2021, we've seen incredible community adoption with thousands of programmers using the product and actively contributing to its development," said Yuval Hazaz, founder and CEO of Amplification. "This funding will enable us to expand use of the platform, which is already supported by a community of programmers in 160 countries."

The platform auto-generates fully functional, human-readable and editable